

EARLY ELECTRIFICATION

By the early 20th century in India, as city populations increased and cityscapes embraced hinterlands, the limitations of steam traction through coal-powered locomotives become obvious to the railway management. Rising passenger traffic in newborn suburbs created a huge demand for cost-effective commute options. Electrification seemed to be the most logical route to escape any strain on rolling stock as well as congestion, and isolated attempts were made at railway electrification.



▲ **More than 500 trains operate on the Harbour Line daily**, the first line to be electrified in India. This picture shows the beginning of the line at Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus (CSMT).